SELF-EMPLOYED · EXPENSES

Tax is charged on your profit, not on what came in.

Work for yourself and you take the costs of the work off your income. What is left is the taxable profit the tax is worked out on.

ONLY THE BUSINESS SHARE

£70 of £200

GOV.UK's own example: a phone bill of £200 for the year, £130 of it personal calls and £70 business. You claim the £70.

> Same with the van, the electricity, the broadband: only the part used for the work.

WHAT YOU CANNOT CLAIM

everyday

Not everyday clothing — suits, shirts, ordinary shoes — even when worn only for work. Protective clothing does count: safety boots, a hard hat.

> Nor travel to a regular workplace, fines, or usually client entertaining. Take the flat £1,000 trading allowance instead and claim no expenses.

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Not sure what counts?

Tell us what sort of work you do and we will point you at the gov.uk pages that apply.

0330 133 1886

General information. For your own situation, speak to an accountant.